was unexpectedly summoned to the bureau of Mossad director Meir Amit. This caught me completely off guard. I was a junior officer, new to the world of intelligence—why would the director of the Mossad for the past year, someone who had served as the head of Military Intelligence and fought in all of Israel's wars, want to see me? As I left the room that I shared with several other employees, I decided to take the stairs rather than use the elevator so I would have a few extra minutes to organize my thoughts before the meeting.

When I reached the Mossad director's office, one of the secretaries informed him that I had arrived and then immediately accompanied me into his room. Meir invited me to sit next to him at his T-shaped desk. It was the first time I had ever visited the office of the director. At the time, I never could have imagined that in twenty-four years I would be the one sitting at that desk, in another office but with the exact same set of furniture that fitted it out in 1965. There were two or three other people sitting in the office whose identity I cannot recall, probably because of my nerves and excitement.

Meir got straight to the point. He spent half an hour describing the entire span of Israel's relations with Iran, including their security relations and intelligence cooperation, which was led by the Mossad. Turning to me, Meir informed me that after considering several candidates, he had found me to be the most suitable replacement for an officer who had been "on loan from the Shin Bet" and was about to complete his two-year service in Iran. I should perhaps point out that at that time the Mossad was for all intents and purposes a hierarchical body that was run like the military, with the exception of uniforms and a jurisdiction of military law—that is to say, a decision was actually an order. Meir added, as an aside, that our service would not be in Tehran but rather in a place defined as a "hardship post"—hence the length of service being only two years. He also mentioned that we would be living undercover there but with a "concession": our local partners, and they alone, would be aware of our true identity. He announced that the date of our departure for Iran was set for January 1966 and that we were to undergo an intensive and multidisciplinary training period. I write *we* because everything that Meir said to me also applied to my wife Yael, whom I had already assumed would be joining me. At the end of the meeting, as I stood up and started heading toward the door, Meir stopped me and told me the following: "We will meet more than once before you